NGO Management System

Quick Start Guide: step by step

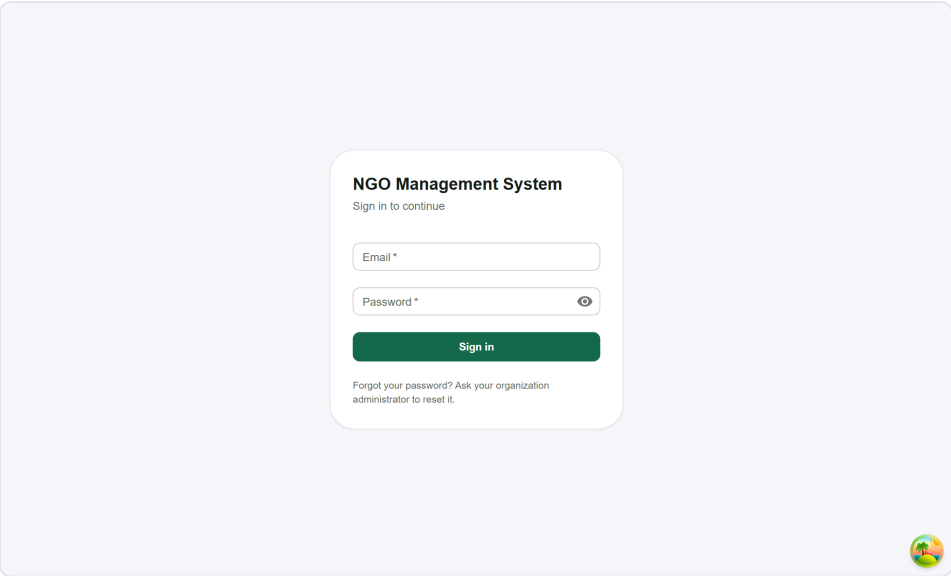
Web address: https://ngo-system-e5af.onrender.com
Your login: sent to you separately (email and password)
Works in: Chrome, Edge or Firefox, on a computer or tablet

Version 1.0 · October 2026

This guide shows the main steps for trying the system. Page 2 explains how to sign in and what each type of user can do. Page 3 shows the order of work. The rest of the guide walks through each step.

1. Sign in

1. Open **https://ngo-system-e5af.onrender.com** in your browser.
2. Enter the **Email** and **Password** you were given, then click **Sign in**.
3. The Dashboard opens. The menu on the left shows only what your login is allowed to use.
4. To leave, open the menu under your name at the top right and choose **Logout**.



> **First visit of the day:** the site may take up to one minute to open while the server starts. After that it is fast.
> **First sign-in:** you are asked to choose your own password. **Forgot it later?** Ask your organization administrator to reset it; you then choose a new one at your next sign-in.

What each user type can do

User type	Can do
Organization Admin	Everything: settings, users and roles, lists (lookups), programs, projects, approvals, reports.
Finance Officer	Budgets, expenses, donors and donations, including **approving** budgets and expenses.
Data Entry	Daily records: beneficiaries, enrollments, enterprises, terms of reference, activity runs, attendance, service deliveries, expenses (to be approved by finance).
Viewer	Can look at everything and run reports, but cannot change anything.

The administrator can also create custom roles (**Administration › Roles**) and choose exactly what each one may do.

2. How the work flows

Work in this order. Each step uses what the earlier steps created, so the lists you need appear in the forms.

1 · Set up
Organization, users, lists (lookups)

2 · Plan
Programs, projects, budgets, terms of reference, activities

3 · Fund
Donors and donations

4 · Do the work
Beneficiaries, activity runs, attendance, service delivery, expenses

5 · Report
Dashboard and reports, with Excel/PDF export

How things connect

Record	Belongs to	Example
Program	The organization	Women and Youth Livelihoods
Project (and its phases)	A program	Small Business Start-up Grants, Phase 1
Activity	A project	Business skills training
Activity run	An activity (one batch, place and dates)	Batch 2, Adigrat town
Attendance session	An activity run	Training session 1, 5 May
Service delivery	A program (and optionally a project, activity or run)	Hygiene kits to 40 households

Statuses: what they mean

Status	Meaning
Planned	Not started yet.
Active	Running: everything can be added.
Suspended	Paused: nothing new can be added until it is Active again.
Completed	Finished: no new plans, but late records (deliveries, attendance, expenses) can still be added.
Cancelled	Stopped: nothing new can be added, and it is not counted in reports.

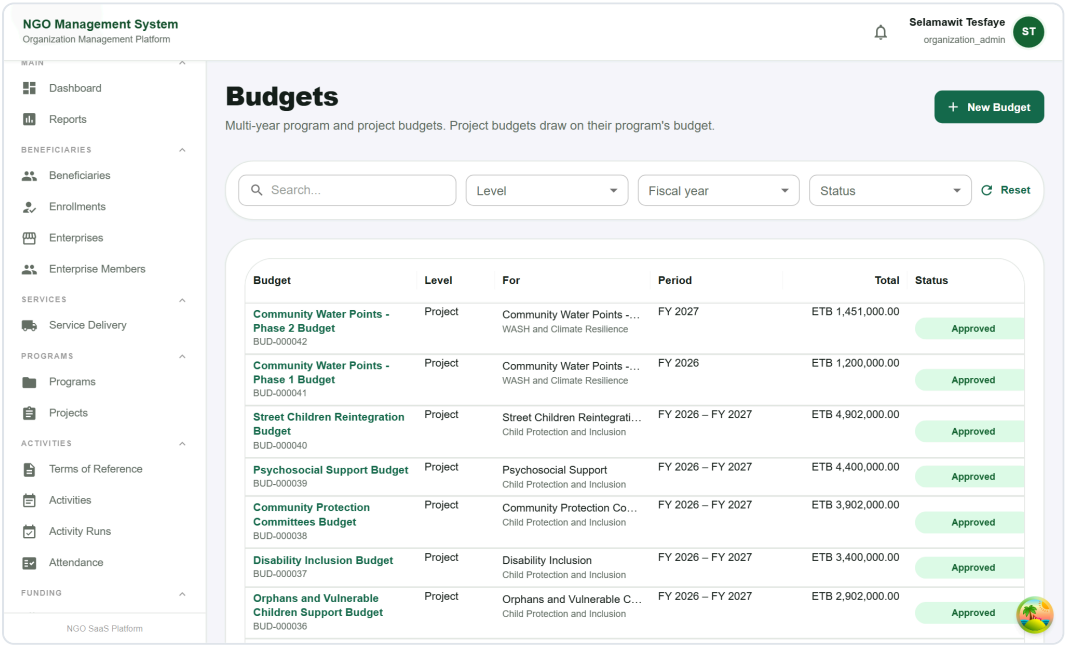
Budgets, terms of reference and expenses go through approval: **Draft** → **Submitted** → **Approved** (or **Returned** for changes).

3. Set up (Organization Admin, once)

1. **Administration › Organization**: check your organization's name, contact and logo.
2. **Administration › User Management › Create User**: create a login for each staff member and choose their role.
3. **Administration › Lookup Management**: review the lists used in forms (service types, items, units, activity types, gender and others), and add your own.
4. **Administration › Custom Fields** (optional): add extra questions to the beneficiary form, for example "Disability type".
5. **Administration › Wording** (optional): use your organization's own words, for example "Fund" instead of "Donation", or "Ongoing" instead of "Active". Screens and reports change at once.

4. Plan the work

1. **Programs › Programs › Add Program**: name, dates, target and status.
2. **Programs › Projects › Add Project**: choose the program, set the donor, manager and dates. For a project in phases, open the project and use **Add Phase** in the Phases card.
3. **Finance › Budgets › New Budget**: budget lines per year (fiscal year = January–December). Click **Submit for Approval**. A finance officer or admin then **Approves** it or **Returns** it for changes.
4. **Activities › Terms of Reference › New TOR**: write the TOR for an activity and submit it. Once approved, the activity can be created from it.
5. **Activities › Activities › Create Activity**: the activity under its project (dates must be inside the project's dates).
6. **Activities › Activity Runs › Create Activity Run**: each batch or round of the activity, with location and dates.



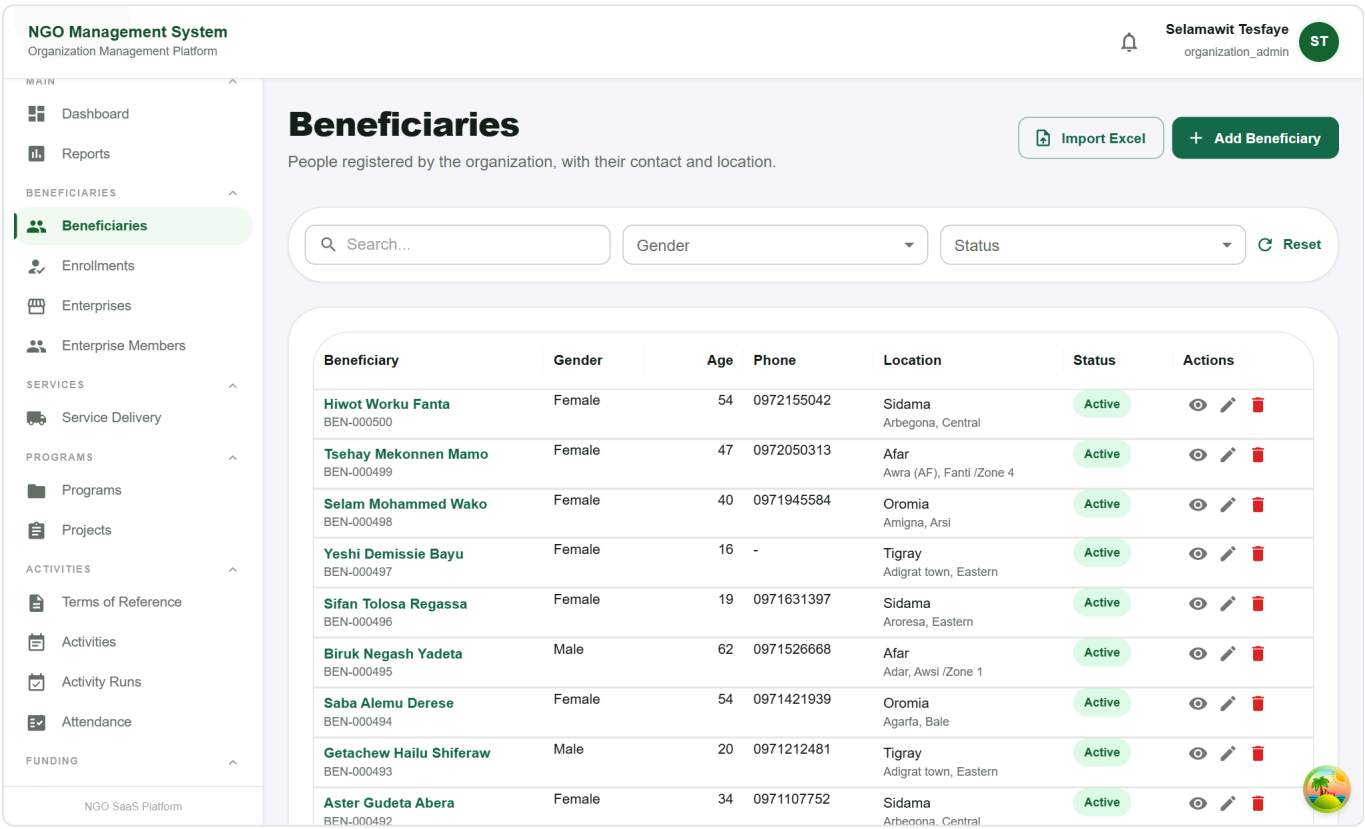
Budgets: each line shows its period, total and approval status.

5. Record funding

1. **Funding › Donors › Add Donor**: the donor's name, type and contact.
2. **Funding › Donations › Add Donation**: donor, amount, currency (ETB, USD, EUR, GBP or CHF) and the program or project it funds. For a foreign currency, enter the exchange rate on the day it was received. Reports also show the value in ETB.
3. Status: **Pledged** (promised) or **Received**. Only received money counts as funding received.

6. Register beneficiaries

1. **Beneficiaries › Beneficiaries › Add Beneficiary**: name, gender, date of birth, phone, and location (choose Region, then Zone, then Woreda).
2. For many people at once, click **Import Excel**, then **Download Template**. Fill in the template and upload it. Rows with problems are listed so you can correct them.
3. **Beneficiaries › Enrollments › Create Enrollment**: enroll each person in the program they belong to.
4. For groups and businesses: **Enterprises** (the group) and **Enterprise Members** (its members).

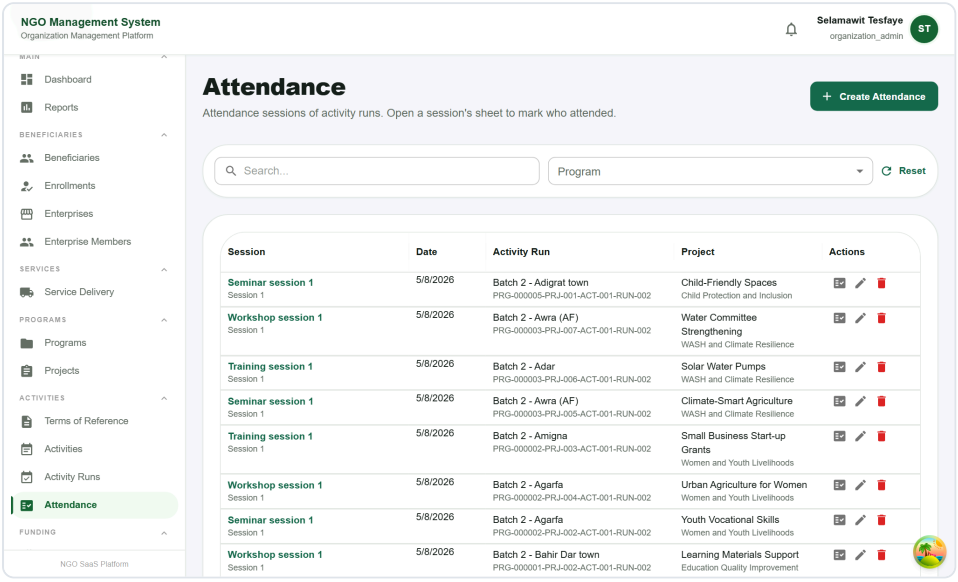


Beneficiaries: search, filter, open, edit, or import from Excel.

7. Record what was done

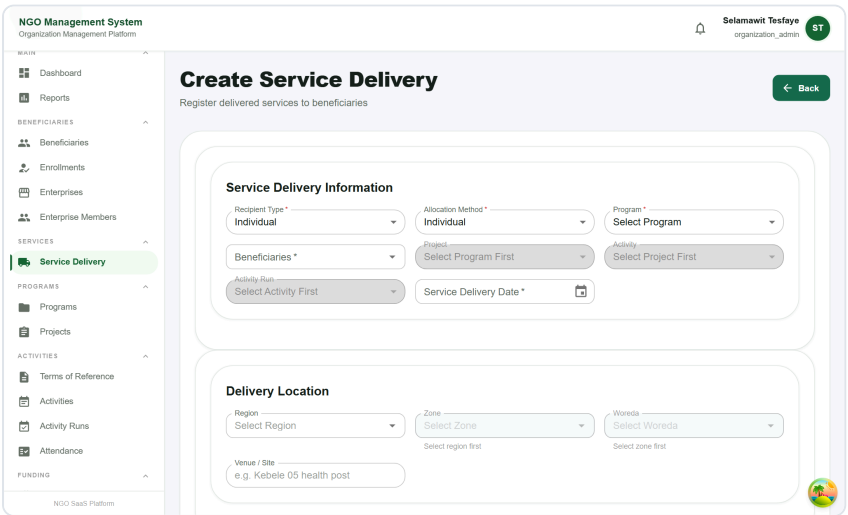
Trainings and meetings: attendance

1. Activities › Attendance › Create Attendance: choose the activity run and the session date.
2. Open the session's **sheet** and mark each person **Present, Late, Excused or Absent**. Enrolled people are listed for you.
3. You can also add other participants: staff, partners, government officials and community members.



Goods, cash and services: service delivery

1. Services › Service Delivery › Create Service Delivery: choose who receives it (individual, household, group or institution) and how it is shared.
2. Choose the program (and project, activity or run if it belongs to one), the date and the location.
3. Add the items (for example hygiene kits or cash) with quantity, unit cost and currency, and pick the people or groups who received them.
4. If the items were bought with an expense, link that expense so the cost is not counted twice.

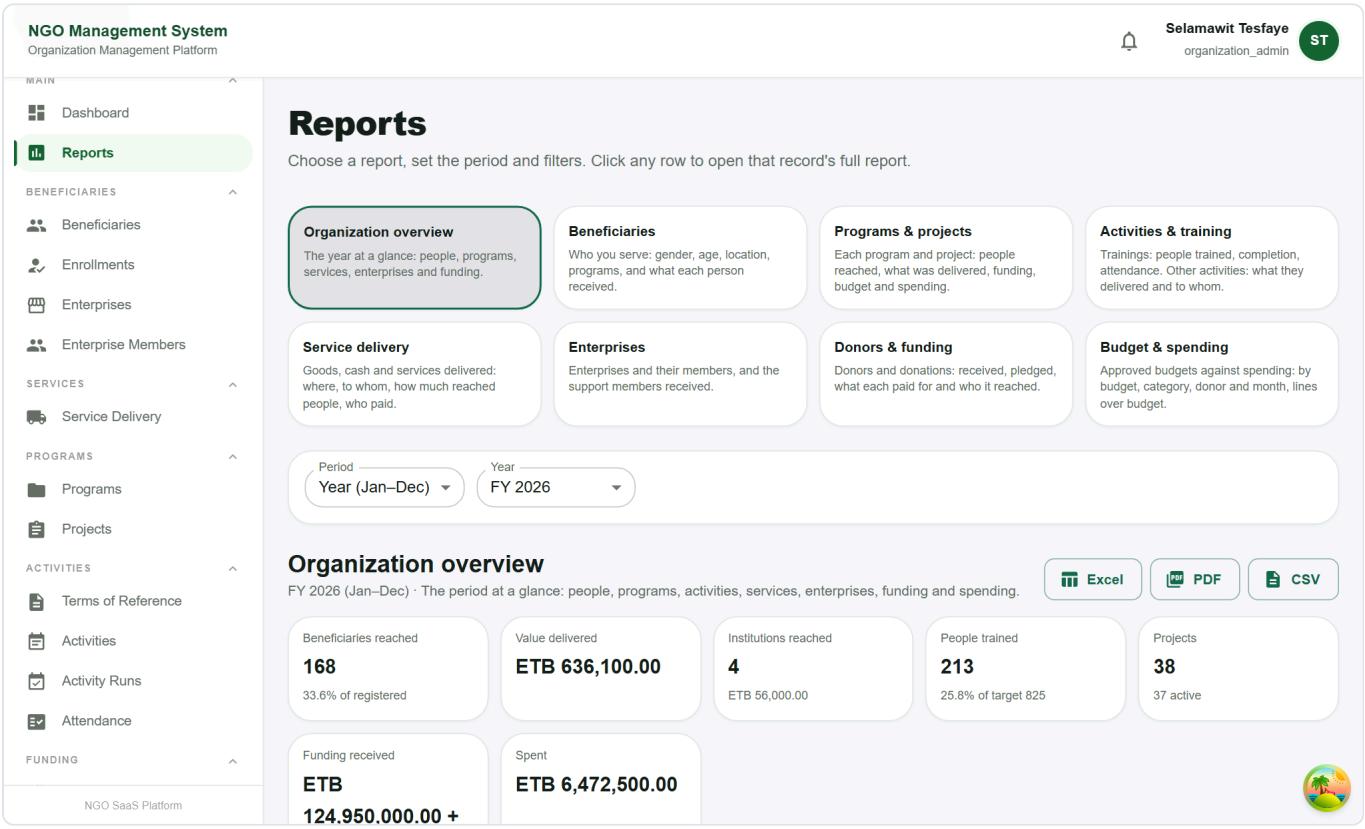


8. Record spending

1. Finance › Expenses › Record Expense: the budget line, amount, date, payment method, receipt or invoice number, and the donation that pays for it.
2. **Submit** it. A finance officer or admin **Approves** it (it then counts as spent and is locked) or **Returns** it for changes. A wrong approved expense can be **Voided**.
3. If a line would go over budget, the system warns you. You can still submit it, but the approver must confirm and give a reason.

9. See results: dashboard and reports

1. Dashboard: the key numbers at a glance.
2. Reports: choose a report (overview, beneficiaries, programs and projects, activities and training, service delivery, enterprises, donors and funding, budget and spending).
3. Choose the **period** (year, half year, quarter, month, date range or all time) and filters such as program, project, region and gender.
4. Click any row to open that record's full report. Download with **Excel**, **PDF** or **CSV**.



10. Good to know

The system checks your entries

- **Dates:** an end date cannot be before its start date. Records must fall inside their parent's dates (for example an activity inside its project's dates). Completed work cannot have a future date.
- **Status:** nothing new can be added to suspended or cancelled work, and inactive people or donors cannot receive anything new.
- **Money:** each amount keeps its own currency. Totals are shown per currency, plus the ETB value where a rate is known.
- If something is refused, the message says which field to check and why.

Tips

- Each list has **Search**, filters and **Reset**. Click a name to open the record.
- Codes (BEN-000123, PRG-000001-PRJ-002 …) are created automatically. Use them when talking about a record.
- Everything you change is saved immediately and recorded in the history (audit log).

> **Trying the system:** the demo organization already has sample data (500 beneficiaries, programs, projects, donations, budgets and reports). Feel free to add, change and approve records. Everything you enter is real in the demo and can be reset afterwards.

Need help?

Contact your system provider with a short description of the problem, the page you were on and a screenshot.